

40 Adding “-ever” to question words

Adding “-ever” to question words changes their meaning. These new words modify the question words to mean “no matter” or “it doesn’t matter.”

 **New language** Words with “-ever”

Aa Vocabulary Chance and weather phrases

 **New skill** Joining a clause to a sentence

40.1 KEY LANGUAGE QUESTION WORDS WITH “-EVER”

You can use “-ever” words as subjects, objects, or adverbs in their own clauses. They can also be used to join a clause to the rest of a sentence.



I’m still going to the game, **whatever** the weather’s like.

[It doesn’t matter what the weather is like. I’m still going.]



We can take a taxi or walk, **whichever** you prefer.

[It doesn’t matter to me which you choose, taxi or walking.]

Here, “whichever” is an object.



Here, “whoever” is a subject.

Whoever invented the umbrella was a very clever person indeed.

[I don’t know who invented the umbrella, but they were very clever.]



It always seems to rain **whenever** I go away.

[Any time I go away, it rains.]



I always check the forecast for **wherever** I’m going to be.

[I check the forecast for the place I am going to be, no matter where it is.]

Here, “however” is an adverb.



If there’s a chance of rain, **however** small, I’ll take an umbrella.

[I’ll take an umbrella, no matter how small the risk of rain.]

